

12/02/2025

★ Caste in Modern India:

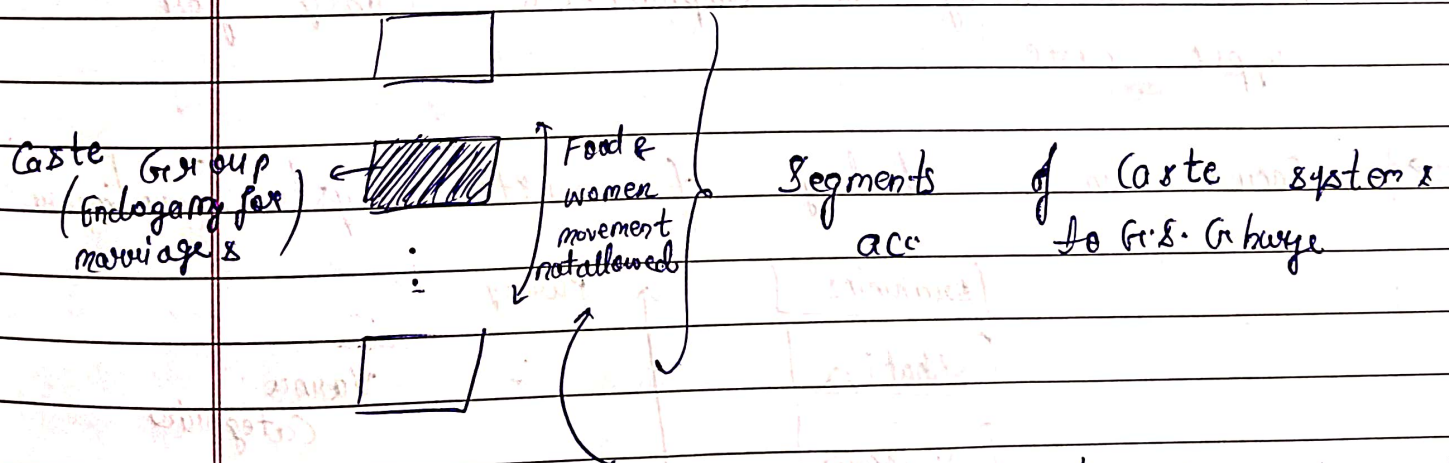
Caste → Empirical → (is) something we can see. e.g. "weather today"

→ Normative → (should questions) & (Ought question)
eg "We should tell the truth"

Morphology → structure of something / organisation of something.

→ Untouchability : empirical practice.

Social distancing in Covid but already practiced in Caste system as untouchability.



very strong part of Caste system as there will be CONTAGIOUS for ^{upper} caste groups

→ Food & Women → acc. to G.S. Ghurje "Restrictions on feeding & Social Intercourse."

• Commensality → what kind of food.

etc. Food cooked by other lower caste not eaten by upper caste.

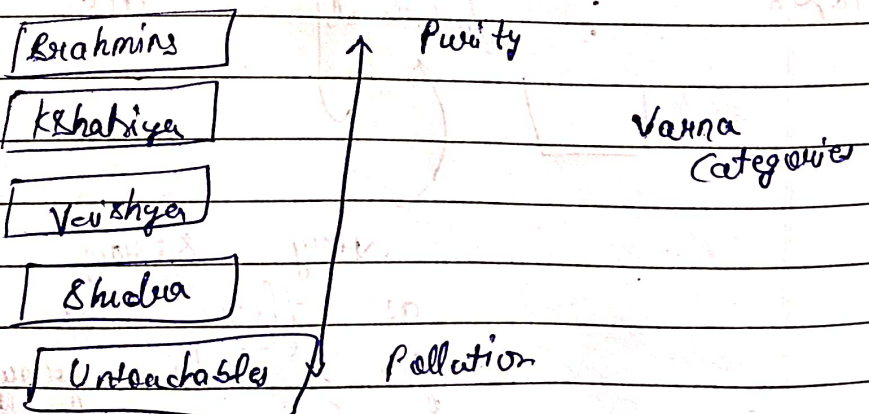
• In modern India → caste system has changed since we don't have practices of untouchability & circulation of food & women.

• Book view :

→ Brahmanical view → views of upper caste

→ Ritual hierarchy are emphasized (only for upper caste)

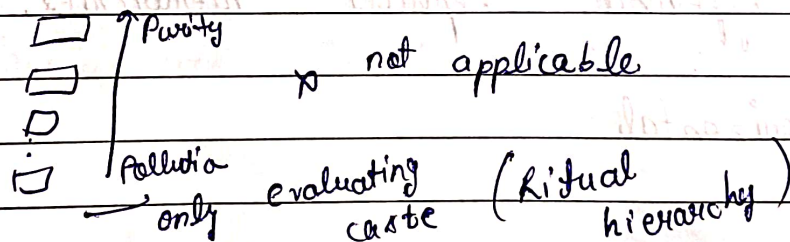
→ Focus on ideology of caste system. (pure/impure)



- It doesn't help us to understand the empirical system of caste.
- It emphasis on tradition / continuity with past.
- Systemic / structural aspect highlighted.
- Universalist (ignore local realities)
 e.g. All Brahmins are not vegetarians (Bengali Brahmin)

• Field view:

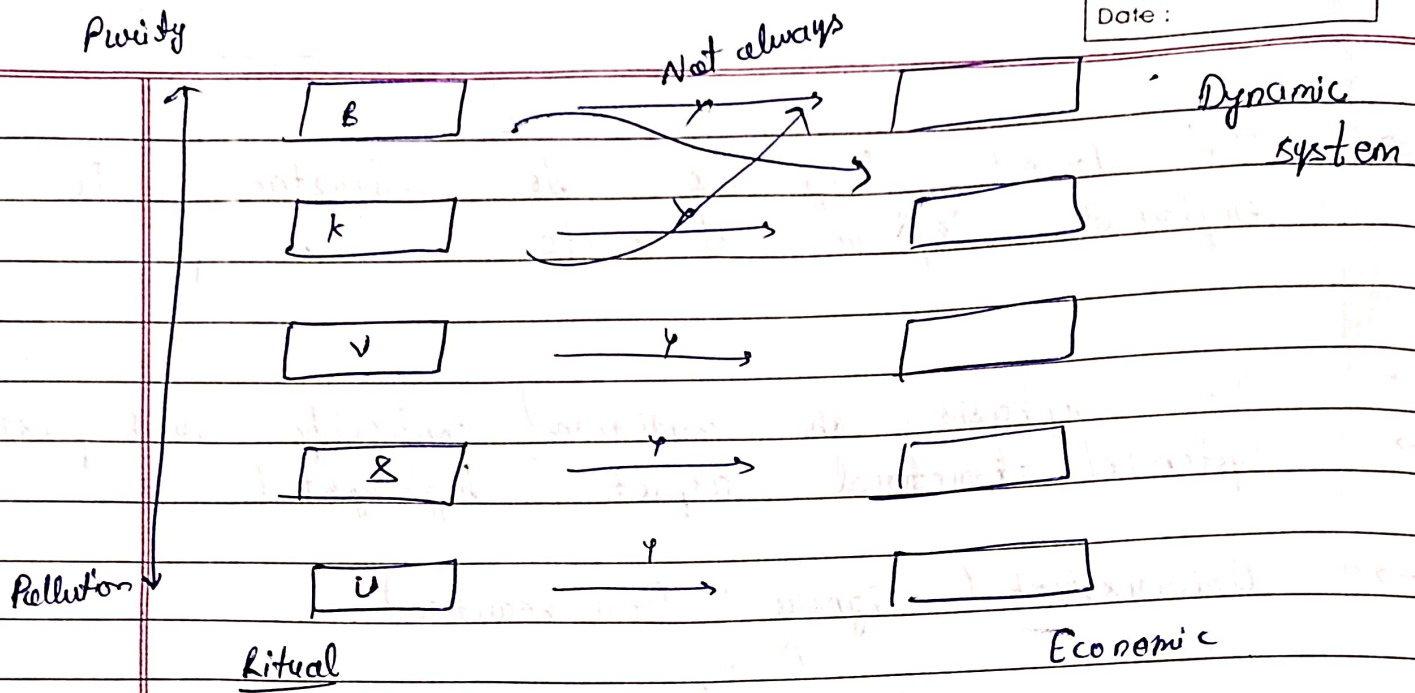
- The vertical / hierarchical structure collapse



- There are multiple hierarchies which can be made use of different evaluation criteria.

"Multiple evaluation criteria"

e.g. Economic instead of Ritual



e.g. Patels of Gujarat (Shudra are on the top of Economic hierarchy)

→ Multiple meanings

→ " Difference replaces hierarchies. in Modern India

→ Horizontal

* Is Caste System relevant today

No

Yes

• Post-Independence changes in caste:

→ Constitutional

provision

Caste purity de-recognized

Right to life & equality as Fundamental

Notification of SCs Reservation.

→ Caste panchayats de-recognized.
(Not a constitutional provision)

• Social changes:

→ Greater horizontal solidarity

↗ Economic & political unification
 ↗ Roads & Railways
 → Breakup of 'Village community'

→ Caste mobility in Economic hierarchy.

→ Economic opportunity / job flexibility.

→ Caste as ideology (normative structure of caste)
Ideology remains still today (Book v/s field).

* Caste Ideology v/s Practice:

→ Hierarchy
Caste as morphology (empirical existence of caste, as organizational principle)

→ Difference
Politics around Caste system.